JOHN C. WALTHER

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EDUCATION

Vanderbilt University **Nashville, TN**

Expected Graduation Date: May 2029

- GPA: 4.0/4.0
- Expected Major: Mechanical Engineering
- Expected Minors: Engineering Management, Digital Fabrication, and Innovation and Design Strategy
- National Merit Scholarship Recipient
- Vanderbilt University Merit Scholarship Recipient

New Trier Township High School **Winnetka, IL**

Graduation Date: June 2025

- Weighted GPA: 5.33/5.33; Unweighted GPA: 4.0/4.0 (Honor Roll); Valedictorian
- Testing: 36/36 ACT, 11 AP Tests taken (received 5/5 on 10 of the tests)
- Class of 2025 Achievement in Mathematics Award, Achievement in Science Award, and Achievement in Social Studies Award
- Illinois State Scholar

IN-Focus College Preparation Program at Northwestern University **Evanston, IL**

- So You Want To Build a Robot? Mechatronics and Electromechanical Design (First Place in Final Class Competition)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Vanderbilt University Welding Automation Lab (VUWAL) **Nashville, TN**

Research Assistant: Summer 2026 - Present

- Research the use of friction stir welding techniques on thin sheets of nitinol
- Funded by Frist Center for Autism and Innovation Summer Internship Program

The Wond'ry, Vanderbilt's Center for Innovation and Design **Nashville, TN**

Summer Intern: Summer 2026

- Helped design Launchpad Career Studio, a summer workshop for college students to advance their careers
- Collaborated with Professor Kevin Galloway

International Motor Sports Association **Road America, Elkhart Lake, WI**

Engineering Intern: Summer 2025 at the Motul SportsCar Grand Prix

- Shadowed Scott Ellison (Lead IMSA Technical Compliance & Scrutineering Manager)
- Assisted with technical inspections and on-track inspections

New Trier Applied Arts Department **Winnetka, IL**

Automotive Engineering Teaching Assistant: Fall 2024 – Spring 2025

- Instructed MIG welding to beginners and assisted with projects pertaining to engines, electric go carts, and car parts

Northern Suburban Special Recreation Association **Highland Park, IL**

Program Assistant: Summer 2023 – Summer 2025

- Worked one-on-one with individuals with special needs during social and athletic activities

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

VU Motorsports (Formula SAE at Vanderbilt University)

Member: 2025 – present

New Member Lead: 2026 - present

- Assisted in assembly of chassis
- Designed oil tank and system to test torsional stiffness of new car

VUcept

Member: 2026 – present

- Selected to lead a six-week freshman orientation group of 20, working alongside a faculty partner
- QPR Suicide Prevention certified

Tikkun Olam Makers Vanderbilt

Member: 2025 – present

- Assisted in designing and building an adaptive shower chair and table for a child with muscular dystrophy

Vanderbilt Club Baseball

Vice President: 2026 - Present

Member: 2025 – 2026

- Role: Pitcher

Skills

CAD Software: SolidWorks and Autodesk Fusion 360
Fabrication Tools: MIG welding, friction stir welding, plasma CNC, tube bending and fitting, sheet metal forming, 3D printing
Other Skills: Technical drawing, manual machining and hand fabrication